



8th Grade English Language Arts

M/J Language Arts 3 (Florida course 1001070) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · Six great books, read slowly and written about honestly

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions, so the week-to-week experience varies; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Over the year your scholar reads six works closely and writes back to them: a Regency novel of self-knowledge, a science-fiction story about what makes us human, a short poem about wonder, a parable of boys without law, a story about an unexamined tradition, and a novel about the cost of justice. The habits are classical and concrete. Scholars retell chapters in their own words, copy passages worth knowing into a writing notebook, memorize a small repertoire from each book and say it aloud, imitate model paragraphs, and write argumentative essays that state the strongest objection to their own position and answer it plainly. VR experiences and small interactive activities accompany the reading; they never replace it.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 6 MODULES · 35 WEEKS · 175 LESSONS

Module · Text	Weeks	Lessons	Quarter	Central question & module projects
1 · <i>Emma</i> — Jane Austen	10	50	Q1–Q2	How does a person come to know herself well enough to act rightly? — Parts of Speech project, Character Collage in VR , final argumentative essay + recitation
2 · <i>Out of the Silent Planet</i> — C. S. Lewis	6	30	Q2	What does it mean to be human? — first-contact short story , "Set the Scene" in VR, recitation
3 · "When I Heard the Learn'd Astronomer" — Whitman	1	5	Q2	Can a science of stars replace the wonder of looking? — Juxtaposition poem performed under a VR night sky; full poem memorized
4 · <i>Lord of the Flies</i> — William Golding	7	35	Q3	When civilization falls away, what is left of us? — final argumentative essay , "Set the Scene" in VR, recitation
5 · "The Lottery" — Shirley Jackson	2	10	Q3	What evil hides in an unexamined tradition? — "roll a story" short story , recitation
6 · <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i> — Harper Lee	9	45	Q4	What does justice cost, and what does it ask? — Analysis project, creative scene in Lee's voice, final argumentative essay , end-of-year recitation

A TYPICAL WEEK — FIVE LESSONS

Day	Lesson (~50 min each)
Mon	Grammar 1 — fall: Shurley grammar review; spring: writing style & literary technique. One <i>ungraded</i> practice activity, on screen or as a printable PDF.
Tue	Literature 1 — reading, retelling, close reading. One graded interactive activity.
Wed	Grammar 2 — same pattern as Monday.
Thu	Literature 2 — copywork, comparison, written response. One graded interactive activity.
Fri	Literature 3 / Friday Check-up — discussion, quick write, or memorized-passage check. Project submissions land here.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week — the school's designated planning figure for this course: five lessons of about 50 minutes, Monday through Friday. Roughly **100 min** grammar (2 lessons) + **150 min** literature (3 lessons), with the week's reading woven through. **Project weeks** (final essays, short stories, recitations, VR scenes) can run longer; readers who go slowly should budget extra reading time for the longer novels.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ **Physical copies of the six texts** (novels and stories listed above)
- ▶ A bound **writing notebook** and notecards for memory work
- ▶ A computer with a web browser — interactive activities open right on the lesson page
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus — used for setting walks, scene-building projects, discussions, and gallery walks; asynchronous alternatives (e.g., threaded discussions) are provided

GRADING AT A GLANCE

Category	Weight	Includes
Daily Practice	30%	Reading, writing notebook, grammar, reading checks
Major Works	30%	Final essays, creative projects, recitations
Composition	25%	Quick writes, imitations, paraphrase, narrative
Friday Check-ups	15%	Weekly reflection, recitation, discussion entries

SHARED & OPTIONAL WORK

- ▶ VR **gallery walks**: scholars post creative projects and visit two peers' work
- ▶ Discussions run live in VR or as threaded posts — scholars may use either
- ▶ Memorized passages are said aloud at the end of each book and at year's end

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study: assignments open at the start of each quarter and close at its end, with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, conferencing on essays, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.